Tag Helpers are additions to Razor syntax that you use to customize the HTML generated in your templates. Tag Helpers can be added to an otherwise-standard HTML element, such as an `<input>`, to customize its attributes based on your C# model, saving you from having to write boilerplate code. Tag Helpers can also be standalone elements and can be used to generate completely customized HTML.

NOTE Remember that Razor, and therefore Tag Helpers, are for server-side HTML rendering. You can't use Tag Helpers directly in frontend frameworks like Angular and React.

If you've used legacy (.NET Framework) ASP.NET before, Tag Helpers may sound reminiscent of HTML Helpers, which could also be used to generate HTML based on your C# classes. Tag Helpers are the logical successor to HTML Helpers, as they provide a more streamlined syntax than the previous, C#-focused helpers. HTML Helpers are still available in ASP.NET Core, so if you're converting some old templates to ASP.NET Core, you can still use them. But if you're writing new Razor templates, I recommend using only Tag Helpers, as they should cover everything you need. I don't cover HTML Helpers in this book.

In this chapter you'll primarily learn how to use Tag Helpers when building forms. They simplify the process of generating correct element names and IDs so that model binding can occur seamlessly when the form is sent back to your application. To put them into context, you're going to carry on building the currency converter application that you've seen in previous chapters. You'll add the ability to submit currency exchange requests to it, validate the data, and redisplay errors on the form using Tag Helpers to do the legwork for you, as shown in figure 18.1.